

How to Use Your Utility Usage + Trend Tracker

SKU OPS-007 • UTILITY USAGE + TREND TRACKER

What this workbook does

Tracks monthly utility bills (electric, gas, water, internet, trash, propane) per property in a 12-column matrix. Surfaces \$/night, YoY trend, and "anomaly" flags when a month's bill jumps >25% vs prior year — catches leaks, unmonitored loads, and pricing changes.

First-time setup (10 min)

1. **Property Roster** — list properties + utility provider per service (Sevier Electric, Spectrum, etc.)
2. **Settings** — anomaly threshold (default 25% YoY jump), seasonal baseline notes.
3. **Prior-Year Baseline** — paste last 12 months of bills if you have them; otherwise fill in as you go.

Every month

1. Bills arrive (paper, email, or auto-pulled from utility portal).
2. Log a row per service per property: month, \$ amount, kWh / gallons / GB consumed, notes.
3. The 12-Column Matrix auto-computes:
 - \$/night (utility cost ÷ booked nights that month)
 - YoY delta (vs same month prior year)
 - Anomaly flag (>25% YoY jump)

Reading the outputs

- **\$/night per service** — useful for properties with utilities included in rate
- **Anomaly flags** — investigate. Common causes: leak (water spike), guest left HVAC on max for 5 days (electric spike), supplier rate hike (gradual trend)
- **YoY trend per service** — gives advance warning when supplier raises rates

Common anomaly patterns

- **Water bill 2x normal** → leak (toilet, dishwasher, irrigation). Call plumber immediately.
- **Electric bill 1.5x normal in shoulder season** → HVAC running with windows open OR pool/hot tub heater stuck on
- **Internet bill creeping up annually** → ISP gradual rate hikes; shop alternatives every 24 months

- **Propane consumption spikes** → tank gauge wrong OR theft (yes, this happens)

Cost-allocation for tax

For Schedule E filers, utilities flow into Line 18. The per-month matrix is the audit-defense record showing the bills ARE rental-property-related.

Questions?

hello@thestrledger.com — real humans, fast replies.

Pair with: TAX-002 Single-Property P&L (utility expense flows to Line 18), OPS-006 Maintenance Log (when an anomaly = leak, work order goes here), FIN-005 YoY Comparison (annual utility-cost trend in YoY context).